

# Sally Tsai

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## EDUCATION

### Harvard University, Harvard Kennedy School

Cambridge, MA

*Master in Public Administration in International Development (MPA/ID)*

*Sep 2025 – Jun 2027*

- Coursework: Advanced Microeconomic Analysis (API-110), Macroeconomics (API-120), Advanced Quantitative Methods (API-210), Politics of Development (DPI-410)

### University of Toronto

Toronto, Canada

*B.A. in Political Science and Public Policy, High Distinction — GPA: 3.7/4.0*

*Sep 2021 – Jun 2025*

- University of Toronto Admission Scholarship (full first-year tuition); Dean's List 2022–2024

## RESEARCH

### “The Security Premium: Why Taiwan Maintains the World’s Most Restrictive Policy toward Chinese Electric Vehicles” (2026, w/ Wang & Sanchez)

*193-country ordered logit with a  $2 \times 2$  typology (ICE industry size  $\times$  EV adoption); Taiwan is the largest outlier against the industry-lobbying baseline; synthetic control: 29% production divergence post-2016.*

### “VAT Pass-Through in Philippine Pharmaceutical Markets: Evidence from the TRAIN Act” (2026, w/ Vega, PCC/UEA)

*IQVIA MIDAS panel data ( $N=44,339$ ); DiD and triple-difference identify zero consumer pass-through — firms absorbed the 2019 VAT exemption as margin expansion; retail volumes fell 20%.*

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### African Development Bank — Africa Legal Support Facility (ALSF)

Remote

*Consultant (Intern)*

*Jun 2026 – Sep 2026*

- Developing and co-coordinating a four-phase project to build and pilot a Regulatory Framework Assessment (RFA) Diagnostic Toolkit for African Development Bank member states; producing country scorecard, institutional map, and finalized RFA Methodology Guide for AfDB operational use

### Philippine Competition Commission, Economics Office

Manila, Philippines

*Economics Intern*

*May 2026 – Jul 2026*

- Lead-authored working paper on VAT pass-through in Philippine pharmaceutical markets using IQVIA MIDAS product-level panel data; estimated DiD and triple-difference models identifying zero consumer pass-through and a 20% retail volume decline following the 2019 TRAIN Act VAT exemption
- Conducting quantitative analysis of market structure and industrial policy in the Philippines

### Legislator’s Office, Democratic Progressive Party (Rep. Rosalia Wu)

Taipei, Taiwan

*Research and Policy Assistant*

*Jun 2020 – Aug 2024*

- Conducted policy research and data analysis supporting legislative development on cross-strait economic and trade policy; managed data-driven communications strategy, achieving a 47% increase in public engagement

### The Taiwan Gazette, Global Taiwan Studies Program, University of Toronto

Toronto, Canada

*Assistant Editor*

*Nov 2022 – Jun 2025*

- Automated focus group research logistics, achieving a 73% increase in engagement; produced policy analysis on cross-strait political transitions and Taiwan’s international economic position

## LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

### Taiwanese Students Association, University of Toronto

Toronto, Canada

*President (2023–24); Marketing Executive (2022–23)*

*Sep 2022 – May 2024*

- Led 35-person executive team; grew organizational revenue by 98% and expanded programming for 200+ international students

## TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

**Methods:** Causal inference (DiD, staggered adoption, RD, IV, panel fixed effects, event study); ordered logit; synthetic control; OLS with robust SEs; political economy analysis

**Software:** R (tidyverse, ggplot2, MASS, Synth, knitr, Quarto), Stata, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

**Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (native)